

Slym & die padda
monster

Slym & die padda monster

Slym & Paddavoet sit in die klas toe Slym iets buite die klas sien. Hulle het vir juffrou Platanna gesê.

Toe het hulle gaan kyk. Die padda monster het vir Slym gevang.

Juffrou sê toe : Dit is die paddamonster!

Juffrou, sê ek, ek het 'n boek van dit en ek weet hoe om slym terug te kry.

Hoe, vra juffrou Platanna?

Ons moet hom in 'n hok kry en hom in water sit, sê ek.

Alden Esterhuizen

Graad 3 – April 2016

The Tree

The Tree

I lay awake in my bed
The wind howling outside my bedroom
The branch tapping against my window
The same tapping that had always soothed me
“Wait, there is no tree outside my window”
Laying in bed
Pushing my blanket to make way for my sight to
the window
Seeing the window, the branch tapping against it
What I thought was a branch until I saw it
The face
The hunched back
The Finger
Tapping, tapping, tapping
The smile came onto its face
And it was gone the sound of rain took its place
“I’m safe”, I thought until I heard the tapping come
from beneath my bed

Alden Esterhuizen
November 2025

The Closet Door

The Closet Door

Every night I close the door to my closet
Not for any reason
I do it based on the fear of monster under my bed
or my closet
It always made me feel safe until a few night ago
I awoke through the night the closet door askew
but just a little
Every night it kept getting wider, eventually I saw it
I saw the face, the smile that should be impossible
Last night I saw it happen, a hand reach out of the
darkness
Opening the door further, but those fingers were
not of a person
I don't know what to do as during the day there is
nothing
But I fear of what is going to happen as tonight is
the night when it is going to
Be fully opened

Alden Esterhuizen
November 2025

The Sleepwalker

The Sleepwalker

I always slept well, not easily disturbed

I lay in my bed, warmed by my blanket -
And dog laying on my chest
Drifting into the half awake state we all know
Dream slowly being formed

Dreaming for who knows how long

Only being woken by the feeling of a cold breeze
Keeping my eyes shut
Trying to feel for my blanket
Not finding it or feeling my dog
Opening my eyes to only then realise
That the cold I felt is that of the wind

I stood in my driveway
Confused I walked back to my door
Locked
Rattling the lock

Walking around to the bedroom window
Seeing myself in my bed
Through my own window
I, It turned to face the window
A white smile crept onto its face

Alden Esterhuizen
November 2025

The Mirror

The Mirror

I stood up and went to wash my face
The steam from the previous visitor's shower
Showing on the mirror
Throwing cold water on my face
Jolting me awake
Proceeding to brush my teeth
But my reflection
Something's wrong
It's not moving
No, it is
But
It's
Smiling
A knife in hande
Slowly bringing it to his, it's palm
A sting shoots throughout my body
Looking down
My hand is cut
My reflection
Bringing it up to his throat
I see its lips moving
"I will take over"
"I will live in the real world"
I barge out of the bathroom
I cant explain it to anyone
But again I am safe in my room, right?

Then I see it, the mirror against the wall and a
familiar face peeking out
“No”, I scream

Alden Esterhuizen
November 2025